

Create a Management Information Dashboard using MS Excel

Dashboard Design and Creation

1. Dashboard Planning:

- **Purpose:** What insights do you want the dashboard to provide? (e.g., overall sales performance, regional performance, salesman performance, product performance).
- **Key Metrics:** Which metrics are most important? (e.g., total net sales, profit, sales by region, top-selling products).
- **Visualizations:** What types of charts and graphs will best represent the data? (e.g., line charts for trends, bar charts for comparisons, pie charts for proportions).
- **Layout:** Sketch a basic layout for your dashboard. Where will each chart and metric go?

2. Creating Charts and Metrics:

- **Total Net Sales:** Use a cell with a formula like `=SUM(Net_Sales_Column)` to calculate the total net sales. Format the cell as currency. You could also create a small chart showing the trend of total net sales over time.
- **Total Profit/Loss:** Calculate the total profit/loss using a similar formula.
- **Sales by Region:** Create a pivot table with "Region" as rows and "Net Sales" as values. Then, create a bar chart or pie chart from this pivot table.
- **Sales by Salesman:** Similar to sales by region, create a pivot table and chart to show sales performance by salesman.
- **Top-Selling Products:** Create a pivot table with "Product" as rows and "Net Sales" as values. Sort the pivot table by "Net Sales" in descending order. Create a bar chart showing the top 10 or 20 products.
- **Sales Trend over Time:** Create a pivot table with "Month" as rows and "Net Sales" as values. Create a line chart from this pivot table to show the sales trend over time.
- **Number of Customers:** Create charts to visualize the number of customers, perhaps broken down by region or product.

3. Dashboard Layout and Formatting:

- Arrange the charts and metrics on a separate sheet (name it "Dashboard").
- Use clear and concise titles for each chart and metric.
- Label the axes and data points on the charts.
- Use a consistent color scheme and font.
- Consider using shapes or lines to group related elements.

4. **Interactive Elements (Optional, but recommended):**

- **Slicers:** Slicers are a great way to add interactivity to your dashboard. Add slicers for "Region," "Salesman," and "Product." This will allow users to filter the data and see how different regions, salesmen, or products are performing. Connect the slicers to your pivot tables and charts.
- **Dropdown Lists:** You could also use dropdown lists for filtering.

Deliverables:

- The Excel file containing the cleaned data and the dashboard.

Key Tips:

- **Keep it simple:** Don't overcrowd the dashboard with too much information. Focus on the most important metrics.
- **Use clear and concise labels:** Make sure everything is easy to understand.
- **Choose the right chart types:** Use charts that are appropriate for the data you are presenting.
- **Make it visually appealing:** Use a consistent color scheme and font to make the dashboard look professional.